

Multiphysical Topology Optimization of an Electric Machine using Topological Derivatives

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Introduction



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$$\begin{aligned}
 d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)(z) = & \frac{1}{T} \int_0^T \frac{1}{|\omega|} (h_\omega(\operatorname{curl}_\xi K_{\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)} + \operatorname{curl} u(t,z)) - h_\omega(\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)) \\
 & - h'_\omega(\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)) \operatorname{curl}_\xi K_{\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)}, \operatorname{curl} p(t,z))_{\mathbb{R}^2} \\
 & + \frac{1}{|\omega|} ((h'_{\Omega^c}(\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)) - h'_\Omega(\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)) \operatorname{curl}_\xi K_{\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)}, \operatorname{curl} p(t,z))_\omega \\
 & + (h_{\Omega^c}(\operatorname{curl} u(t,z)) - h_\Omega(\operatorname{curl} u(t,z))), \operatorname{curl} p(t,z))_2 \\
 & + (\sigma_{\Omega^c} - \sigma_\Omega) \partial_t u_0(t,z), p_0(t,z) \, dt \\
 & + 2\lambda_\Omega \frac{(\lambda_{\Omega^c} - \lambda_\Omega)^2}{(\lambda_{\Omega^c} - \lambda_\Omega)} (\nabla_x \vartheta_0(z), \nabla_x \phi(z))_2 - (P_{\Omega^c}(u_0(z)) \\
 & - P_\Omega(u_0(z)), \phi(z))_2 + (c_{\Omega^c} - c_\Omega) \vartheta_{\vartheta^*}(\vartheta_0(z)) \\
 & (h_\omega(\operatorname{curl} K_U + U) - h_\omega(U), \operatorname{curl} v)_{\mathbb{R}^2} = -(h_{\Omega^c}(U) - h_\Omega(U), \operatorname{curl} v)_\omega, \quad \forall v \in BL
 \end{aligned}$$

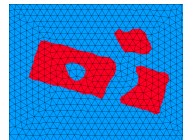
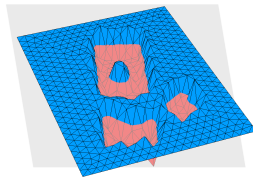
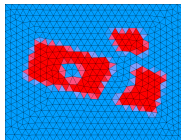
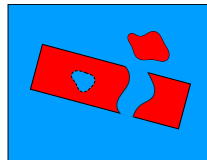
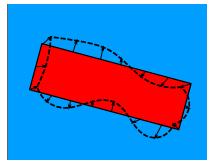
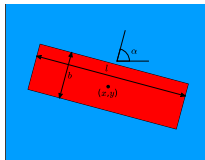
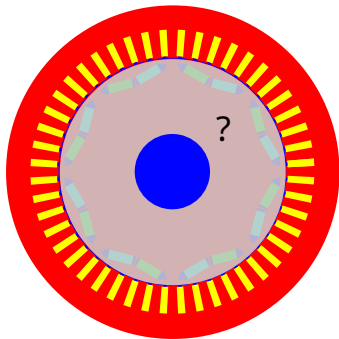
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ÖAW RICAM

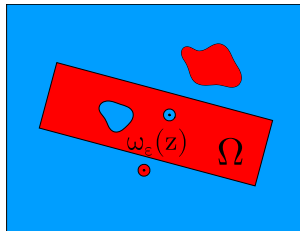
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Motivation

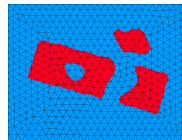
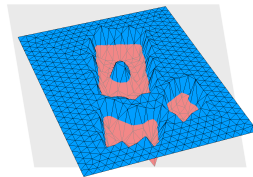
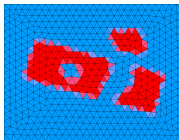
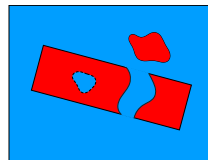
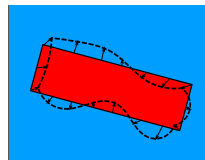
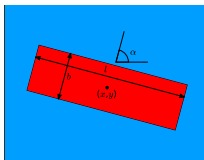


→ Gradient-based Topology opt. with Level-set representation and Topological derivatives

Motivation

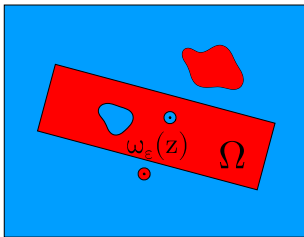


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Finding a minimizer



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Optimality condition

We call a design Ω optimal if

$$d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)(z) > 0$$

Level set function $\psi \in C(\bar{D})$:
$$\begin{cases} \psi(x) < 0 & \Leftrightarrow x \in \Omega, \\ \psi(x) > 0 & \Leftrightarrow x \in \Omega^c. \end{cases}$$

Lemma

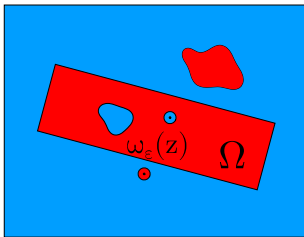
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Fixed point iteration [Amstutz, Andrä, 2006]

- Compute $\mathcal{J}(\Omega), g_\Omega$
- Update $\psi^{k+1} = (1 - s)\psi^k + sg_\Omega$
- Stop if $\angle_{L_2}(\psi, g_\Omega) < \varepsilon$

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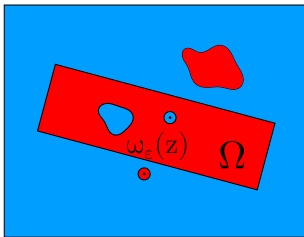
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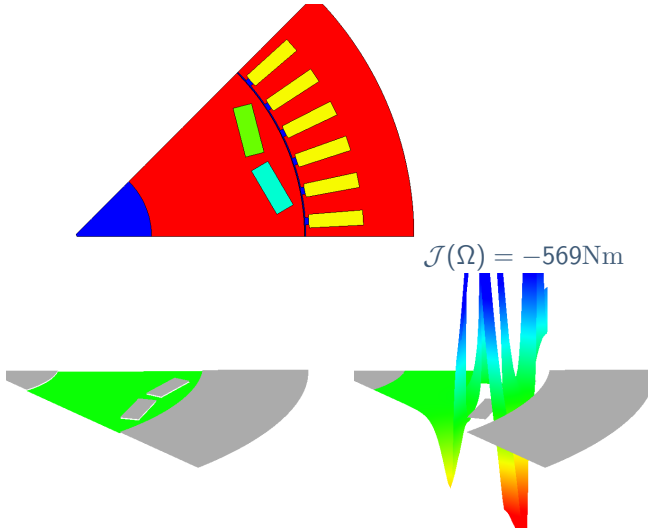
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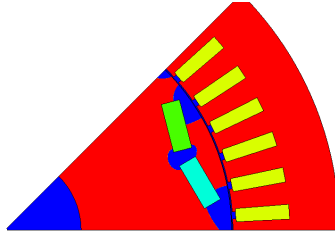
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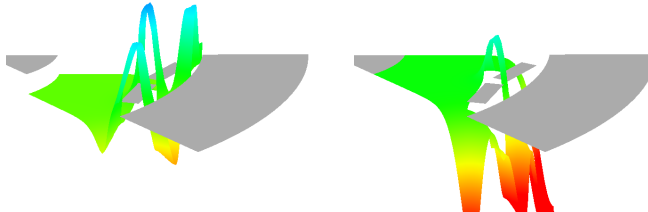
Visualization



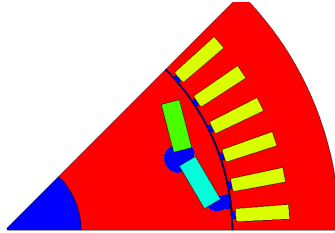
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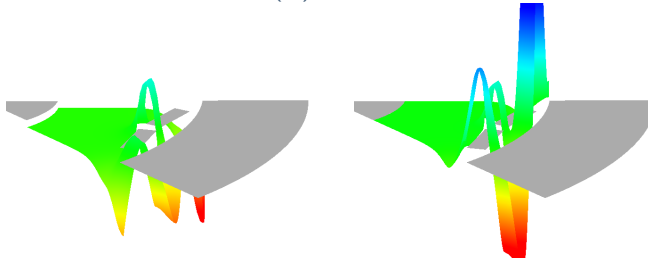
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -738\text{Nm}$$



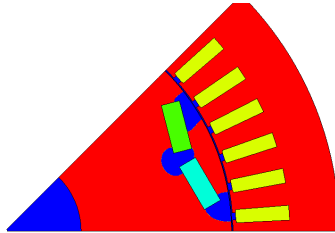
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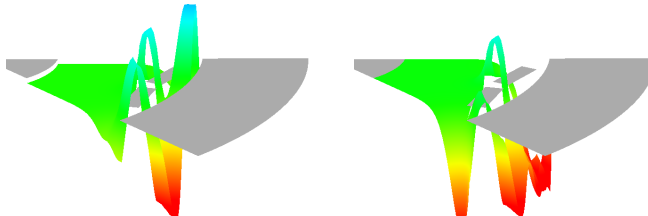
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -772\text{Nm}$$



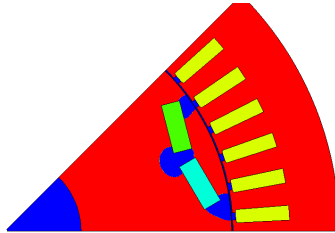
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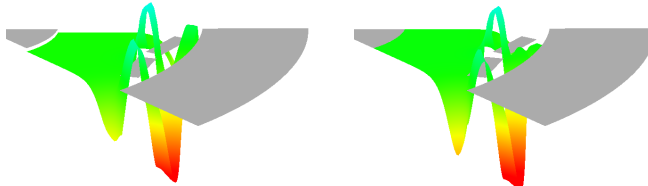
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -793\text{Nm}$$



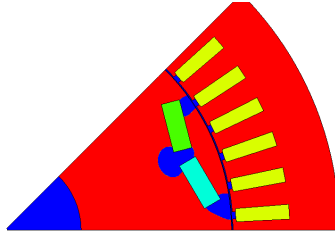
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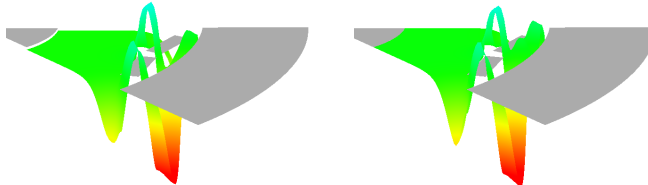
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -823\text{Nm}$$



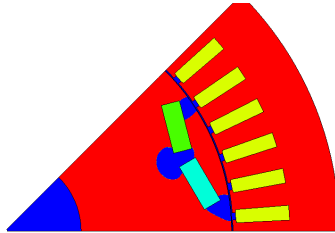
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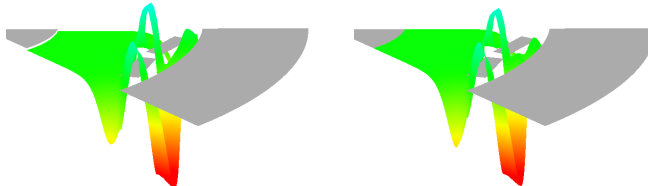
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -823\text{Nm}$$



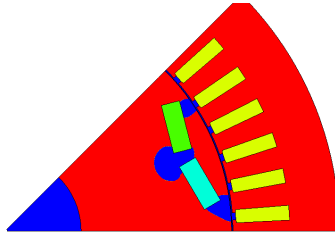
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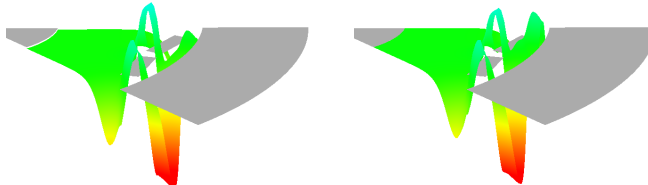
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -831\text{Nm}$$



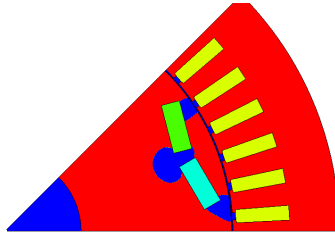
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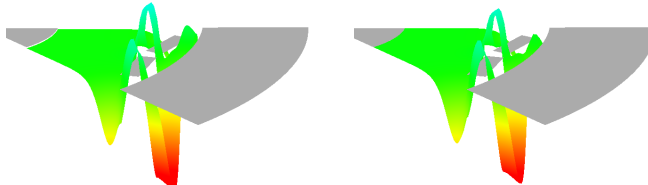
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -833\text{Nm}$$



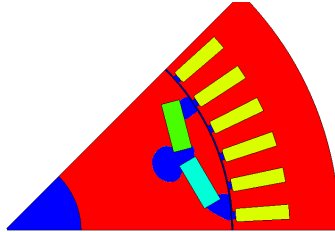
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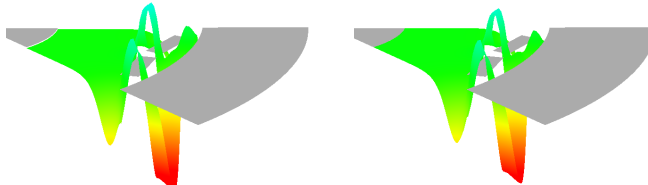
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -834\text{Nm}$$



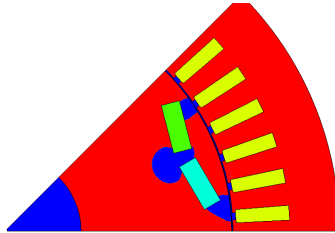
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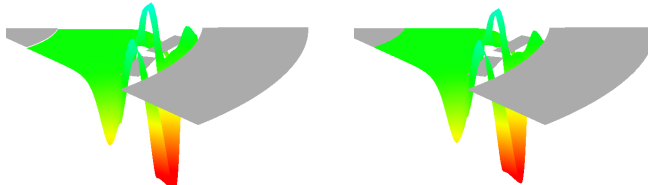
$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -834\text{Nm}$$



Visualization



$$\mathcal{J}(\Omega) = -835\text{Nm}$$



Multi-material level set algorithm [Gangl, 2020]

- Tuple of materials $\Omega = (\Omega_f, \Omega_{m_1}, \dots, \Omega_{m_M}, \Omega_a)$
- Consider all possible material perturbations $\Rightarrow$
Topological derivative in $\mathbb{R}^{N-1}$
- Describe Ω by $N - 1$ -dim. level set function

$$x \in \Omega_k \Leftrightarrow \psi(x) \in S_k \Leftrightarrow N_k \psi(x) > 0$$

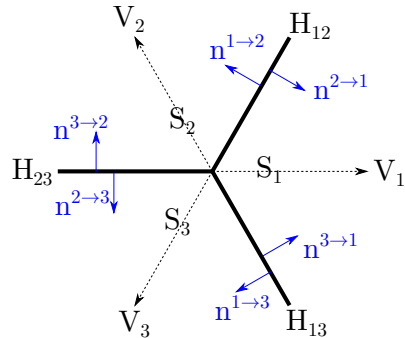
$$N_k := ((n^{i \rightarrow k})^T)_{i \neq k}$$

- Define generalized topological derivative

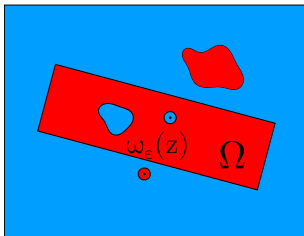
$$d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)^i(x) = (d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)^{i \rightarrow j}(x))_{j \neq i}^T,$$

$$g_\Omega(x) := \sum_{i=1}^N \chi_{\Omega_i}(x) N_i^{-1} d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)^i(x)$$

- Optimality condition $\psi = c g_\Omega, c > 0$
- Volume constraint $\sum_{k \in \mathcal{M}_V} |\Omega_k| \leq V^*$



How to compute the topological derivative [Gangl 2016]



$$d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)(z) = \lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} \frac{\mathcal{J}(\Omega_\varepsilon(z)) - \mathcal{J}(\Omega)}{|\omega_\varepsilon|}$$

Average torque

$$\frac{1}{N} \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} r_\Gamma \int_\Gamma \nu_0 \operatorname{curl} u_\Omega^n \cdot n_\Gamma \operatorname{curl} u_\Omega^n \cdot n_\Gamma^\perp \, ds$$

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■ Compute states u^n and adjoints p^n

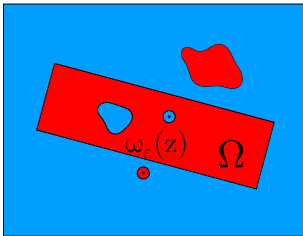
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■ Formula depends on $\operatorname{curl} u^n(z), \operatorname{curl} p^n(z) \in \mathbb{R}^2$,
timesteps n are independent

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- Take samples of $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ in offline phase
- Online evaluation is as cheap as other methods

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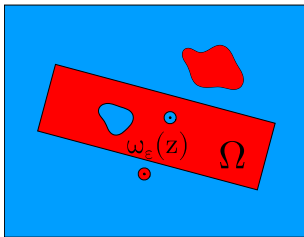
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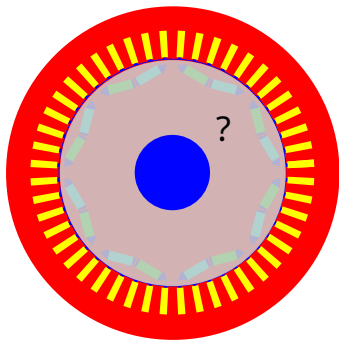
$$\begin{aligned} d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)(z) = & \frac{1}{N} \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} \frac{1}{|\omega|} (h_\omega(\operatorname{curl}_\xi K_{\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)} + \operatorname{curl} u^n(z)) - h_\omega(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)) \\ & - h'_\omega(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)) \operatorname{curl}_\xi K_{\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)}, \operatorname{curl} p^n(z))_{\mathbb{R}^2} \\ & + \frac{1}{|\omega|} ((h'_{\Omega^c}(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)) - h'_\Omega(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)) \operatorname{curl}_\xi K_{\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)}, \operatorname{curl} p^n(z))_\omega \\ & + (h_{\Omega^c}(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z)) - h_\Omega(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z))), \operatorname{curl} p^n(z))_2 \\ & (h_\omega(\operatorname{curl} K_U + U) - h_\omega(U), \operatorname{curl} v)_{\mathbb{R}^2} = -(h_{\Omega^c}(U) - h_\Omega(U), \operatorname{curl} v)_\omega, \quad \forall v \in BL \end{aligned}$$

- Formula depends on $\operatorname{curl} u^n(z), \operatorname{curl} p^n(z) \in \mathbb{R}^2$, timesteps n are independent

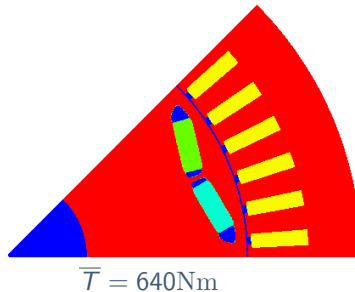
$$d\mathcal{J}(\Omega)(z) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} f(\operatorname{curl} u^n(z), \operatorname{curl} p^n(z))$$

- Take samples of $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ in offline phase
- Online evaluation is as cheap as other methods

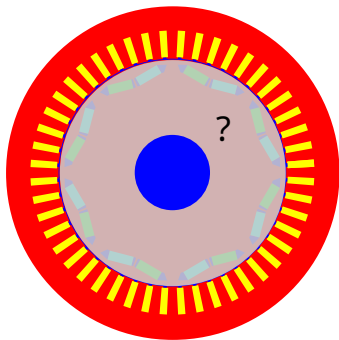
Torque maximization



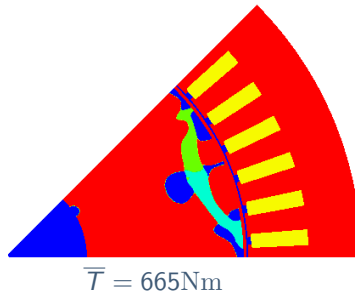
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



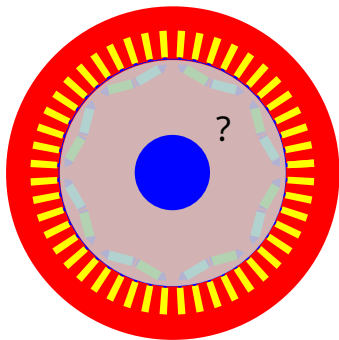
Torque maximization



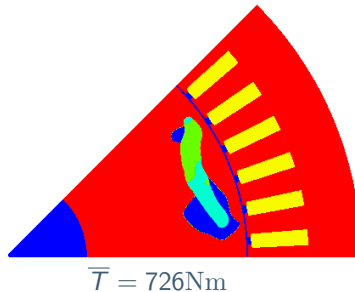
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



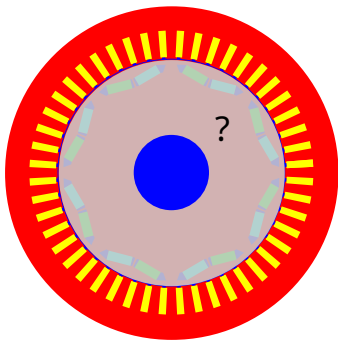
Torque maximization



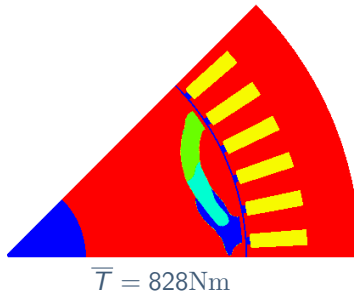
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



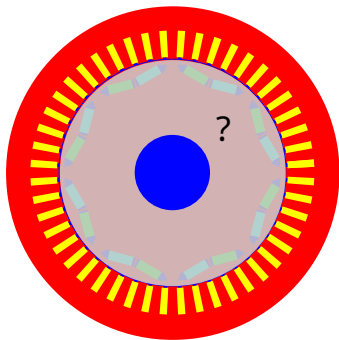
Torque maximization



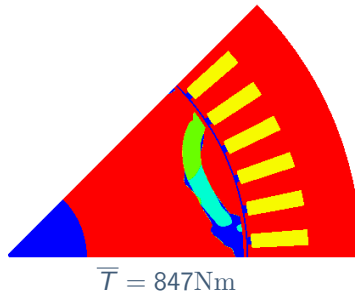
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



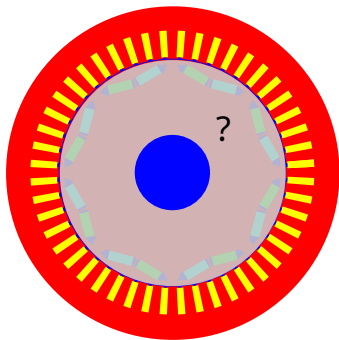
Torque maximization



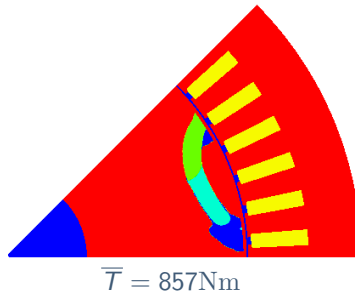
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



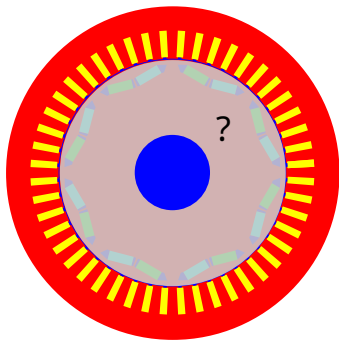
Torque maximization



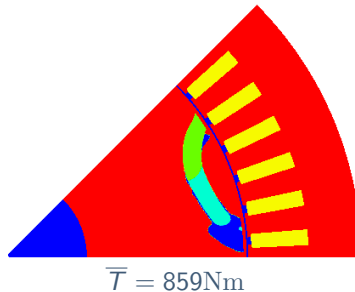
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



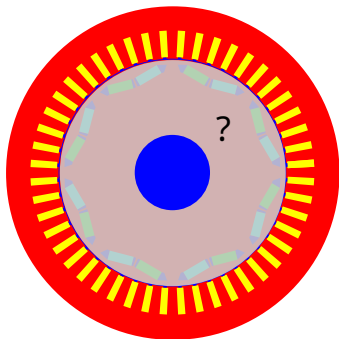
Torque maximization



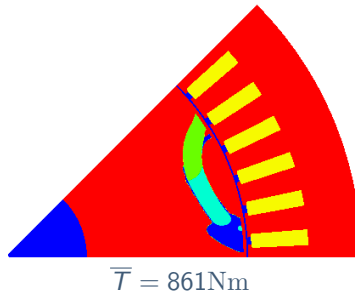
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



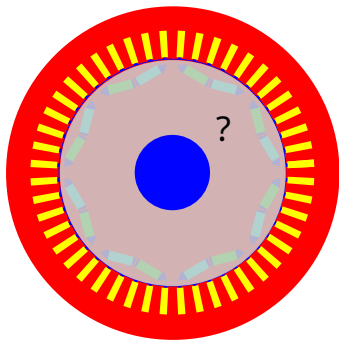
Torque maximization



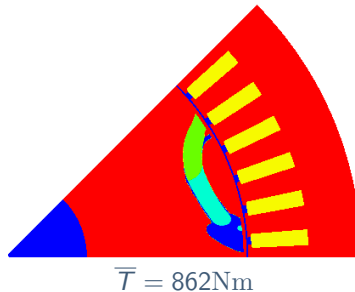
- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque



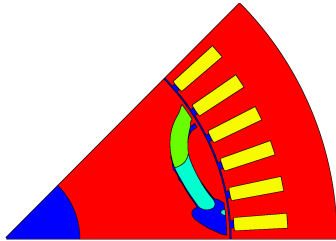
Torque maximization



- Single operating point 16000 rpm, 640Nm
- Fixed direction of rotation
- Restrict magnet volume $|M| \leq 10\%|D|$
- Maximize average torque

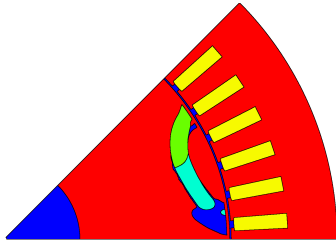


Nice torque, but...



$$\overline{T} = 862 \text{ Nm}$$

Nice torque, but...



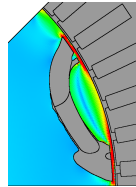
$$\bar{T} = 862\text{Nm}$$



$$\vartheta_{\max} = 210^\circ$$

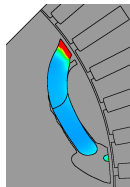
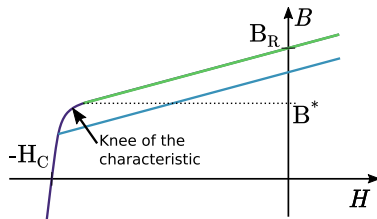


$$B_{\min} = -0.3\text{T}$$



$$\sigma_{\max}^{vM} = 1974\text{MPa}$$

Nice torque, but...



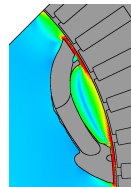
$$\vartheta_{\max} = 210^\circ$$

$$\vartheta^* = 90^\circ$$



$$B_{\min} = -0.3T$$

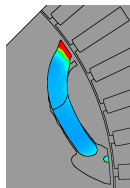
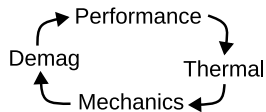
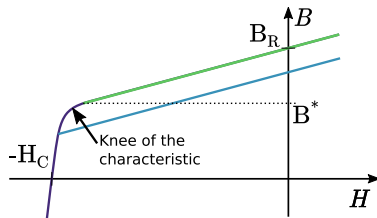
$$B^* = 0.56T$$



$$\sigma_{\max}^{VM} = 1974\text{MPa}$$

$$S^* = 500\text{MPa}$$

Nice torque, but...



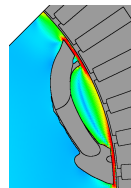
$$\vartheta_{\max} = 210^\circ$$

$$\vartheta^* = 90^\circ$$



$$B_{\min} = -0.3T$$

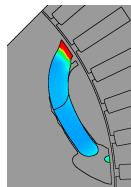
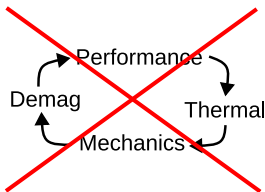
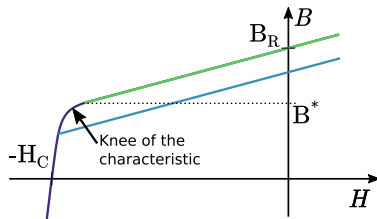
$$B^* = 0.56T$$



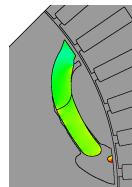
$$\sigma_{\max}^{VM} = 1974\text{MPa}$$

$$S^* = 500\text{MPa}$$

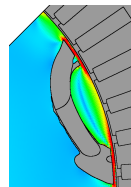
Nice torque, but...



$$\vartheta_{\max} = 210^\circ$$
$$\vartheta^* = 90^\circ$$



$$B_{\min} = -0.3T$$
$$B^* = 0.56T$$



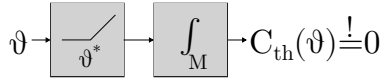
$$\sigma_{\max}^{vM} = 1974\text{MPa}$$
$$S^* = 500\text{MPa}$$

→ All-in-one, add constraints to optimization

Constraints

■ Temperature

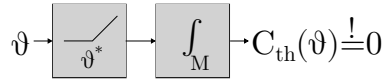
$$-\operatorname{div} \lambda \nabla \vartheta = \frac{\sigma_M}{T} \int_0^T (\partial_t a - \overline{\partial_t a})^2 dt$$



Constraints

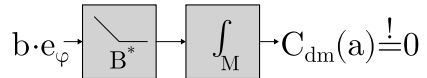
■ Temperature

$$-\operatorname{div} \lambda \nabla \vartheta = \frac{\sigma_M}{T} \int_0^T (\partial_t a - \overline{\partial_t a})^2 dt$$



■ Magnetic fields

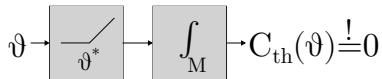
$$\operatorname{curl} h(\operatorname{curl} a) = j$$



Constraints

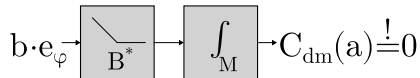
■ Temperature

$$-\operatorname{div} \lambda \nabla \vartheta = \frac{\sigma_M}{T} \int_0^T (\partial_t a - \overline{\partial_t a})^2 dt$$



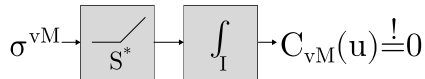
■ Magnetic fields

$$\operatorname{curl} h(\operatorname{curl} a) = j$$



■ Mechanical stresses

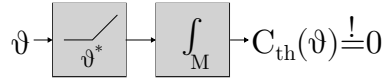
$$-\operatorname{div} \sigma(u) = \rho_I \omega^2 x, \quad \sigma^{vM} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{2} \mathbb{B} \sigma : \sigma}$$



Constraints

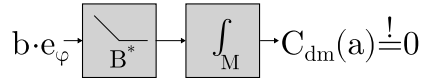
■ Temperature

$$-\operatorname{div} \lambda \nabla \vartheta = \frac{\sigma_M}{T} \int_0^T (\partial_t a - \overline{\partial_t a})^2 dt$$



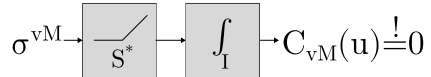
■ Magnetic fields

$$\operatorname{curl} h(\operatorname{curl} a) = j$$



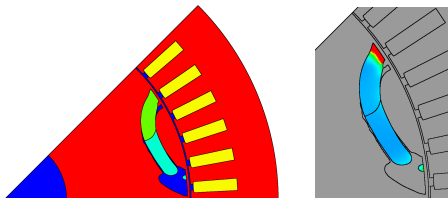
■ Mechanical stresses

$$-\operatorname{div} \sigma(u) = \rho_I \omega^2 x, \quad \sigma^{vM} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{2} \mathbb{B} \sigma : \sigma}$$



$$\rightarrow \min_{\Omega} -\overline{T}(a(\Omega)) + w_{th} C_{th}(\vartheta(\Omega)) + w_{dm} C_{dm}(a^d(\Omega)) + w_{vM} C_{vM}(u(\Omega))$$

Temperature constraint



$$\vartheta^* = 90^\circ,$$

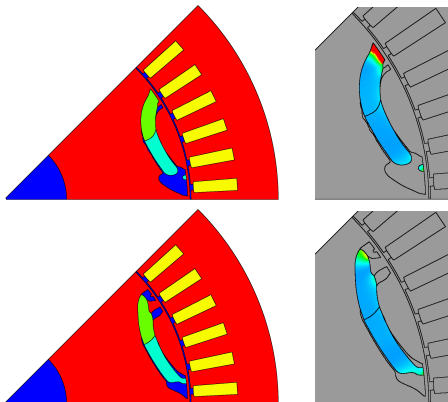
$$\min_{\Omega, |\Omega_m| \leq V^*} \mathcal{T}(\Omega) + w_{th} \mathcal{C}_{th}(\Omega)$$

Constr.	$\mathcal{T}(\Omega)$	$\max \vartheta$
-	862	210



P. Gangl, N. Krenn, “Multi-material topology optimization of electric machines under maximum temperature and stress constraints”, 2025

Temperature constraint



$$\vartheta^* = 90^\circ,$$

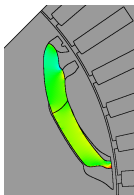
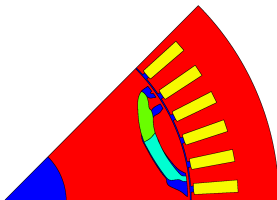
$$\min_{\Omega, |\Omega_m| \leq V^*} \mathcal{T}(\Omega) + w_{th} \mathcal{C}_{th}(\Omega)$$

Constr.	$\mathcal{T}(\Omega)$	$\max \vartheta$
-	862	210
th	845	92



P. Gangl, N. Krenn, “Multi-material topology optimization of electric machines under maximum temperature and stress constraints”, 2025

Demag constraint



$$B^* = 0.56T$$

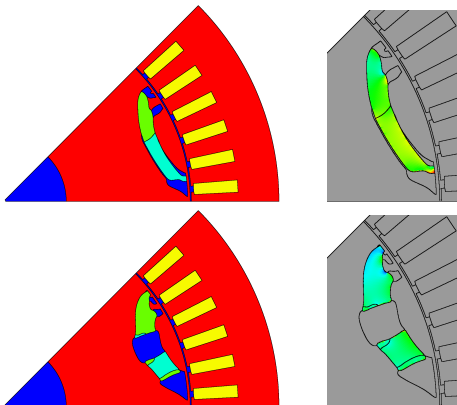
$$\min_{\Omega, |\Omega_m| \leq V^*} \mathcal{T}(\Omega) + w_{th} \mathcal{C}_{th}(\Omega) + w_{dm} \mathcal{C}_{dm}(\Omega)$$

Constr.	$\mathcal{T}(\Omega)$	$\max \vartheta$	$B_{\min}$
-	862	210	-0.3
th	845	92	-0.32



P. Gangl, N. Krenn, "Multi-material topology optimization of an electric machine considering demagnetization", 2024

Demag constraint



$$B^* = 0.56T$$

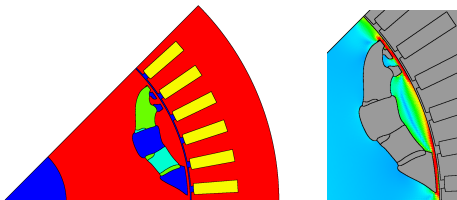
$$\min_{\Omega, |\Omega_m| \leq V^*} \mathcal{T}(\Omega) + w_{th} \mathcal{C}_{th}(\Omega) + w_{dm} \mathcal{C}_{dm}(\Omega)$$

Constr.	$\mathcal{T}(\Omega)$	$\max \vartheta$	$B_{\min}$
-	862	210	-0.3
th	845	92	-0.32
th,dm	774	92	0.41



P. Gangl, N. Krenn, "Multi-material topology optimization of an electric machine considering demagnetization", 2024

Stress constraint



$$S^* = 500\text{MPa}$$

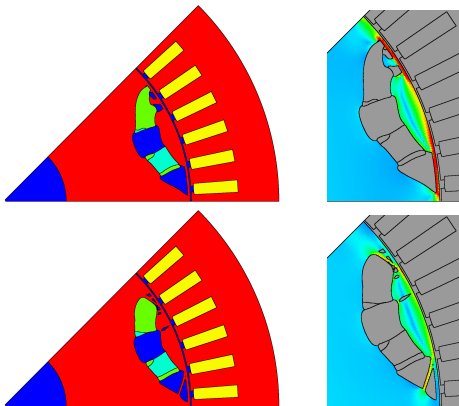
$$\min_{\Omega, |\Omega_m| \leq V^*} \mathcal{T}(\Omega) + \dots + w_{\text{vM}} \mathcal{C}_{\text{vM}}(\Omega)$$

Constr.	$\mathcal{T}(\Omega)$	$\max \vartheta$	$B_{\min}$	$\max \sigma^{\text{vM}}$
-	862	210	-0.3	1974
th	845	92	-0.32	2007
th,dm	774	92	0.41	2338



P. Gangl, N. Krenn, “Multi-material topology optimization of electric machines under maximum temperature and stress constraints”, 2025

Stress constraint



$$S^* = 500\text{MPa}$$

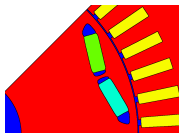
$$\min_{\Omega, |\Omega_m| \leq V^*} \mathcal{T}(\Omega) + \dots + w_{vM} \mathcal{C}_{vM}(\Omega)$$

Constr.	$\mathcal{T}(\Omega)$	$\max \vartheta$	$B_{\min}$	$\max \sigma^{vM}$
-	862	210	-0.3	1974
th	845	92	-0.32	2007
th,dm	774	92	0.41	2338
th,dm,vM	736	88	0.39	498

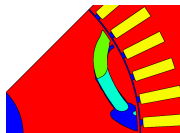


P. Gangl, N. Krenn, “Multi-material topology optimization of electric machines under maximum temperature and stress constraints”, 2025

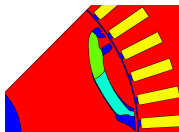
Results



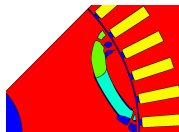
Reference design



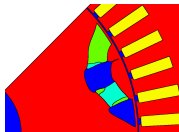
Torque maximization



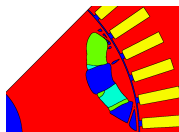
Temp. constraint



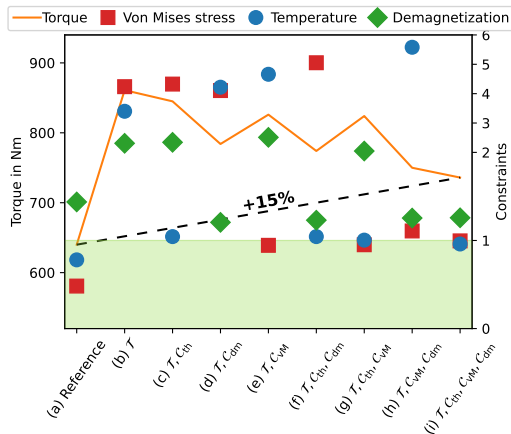
Stress constraint



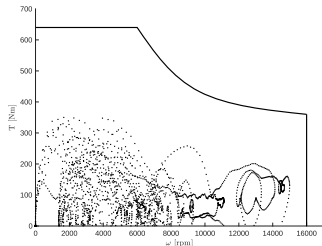
Demag constraint



All constraints



Drive cycle



- Replace average torque by efficiency

$$\mathcal{E}(\Omega) = \frac{E^m}{E^e} = \frac{\sum t_k P_k^m}{\sum t_k (P_k^m + R_S I_k^2(\Omega)/2)}$$

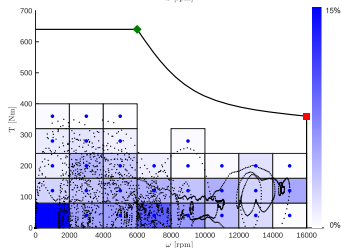
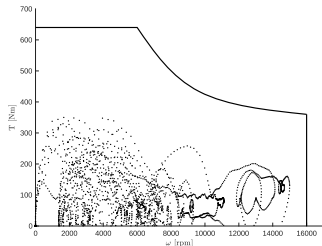
- Current given via MTPA problem

$$I_k(\Omega) = \min_{I, \beta} I, \text{ subject to } \overline{T}(\Omega, I, \beta) = T_k$$



N. Krenn et. al, "Electro-thermal topology optimization of an electric machine by the topological derivative considering drive cycles", IEEE, 2025

Drive cycle



- Replace average torque by efficiency

$$\mathcal{E}(\Omega) = \frac{E^m}{E^e} = \frac{\sum t_k P_k^m}{\sum t_k (P_k^m + R_S I_k^2(\Omega)/2)}$$

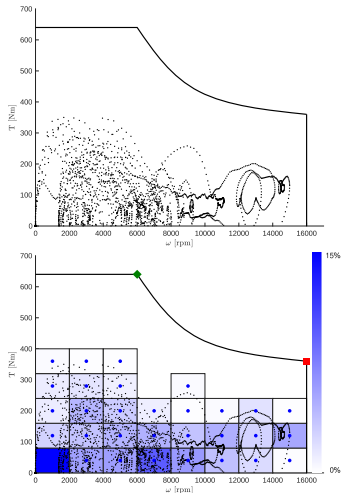
- Current given via MTPA problem

$$I_k(\Omega) = \min_{I, \beta} I, \text{ subject to } \overline{T}(\Omega, I, \beta) = T_k$$



N. Krenn et. al, "Electro-thermal topology optimization of an electric machine by the topological derivative considering drive cycles", IEEE, 2025

Drive cycle



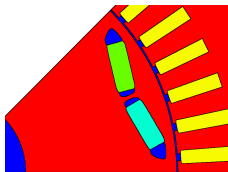
N. Krenn et. al, "Electro-thermal topology optimization of an electric machine by the topological derivative considering drive cycles", IEEE, 2025

- Replace average torque by efficiency

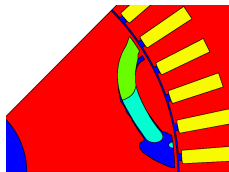
$$\mathcal{E}(\Omega) = \frac{E^m}{E^e} = \frac{\sum t_k P_k^m}{\sum t_k (P_k^m + R_S I_k^2(\Omega)/2)}$$

- Current given via MTPA problem

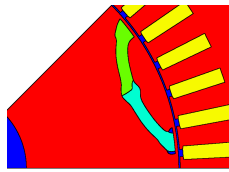
$$I_k(\Omega) = \min_{I, \beta} I, \text{ subject to } \bar{T}(\Omega, I, \beta) = T_k$$



$\mathcal{E}(\Omega) = 99.610\%$

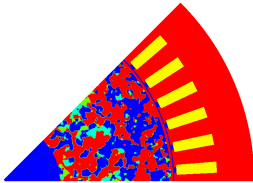
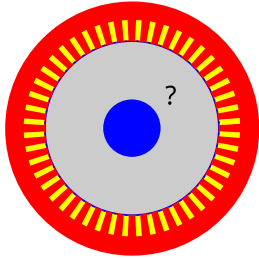


$\mathcal{E}(\Omega) = 99.737\%$

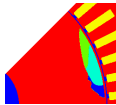
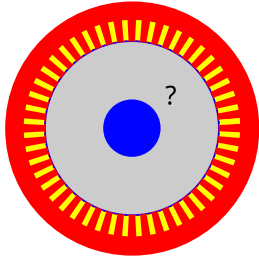


$\mathcal{E}(\Omega) = 99.778\%$

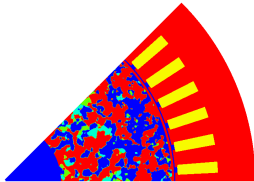
But what about...



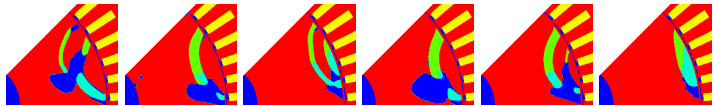
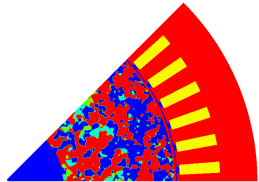
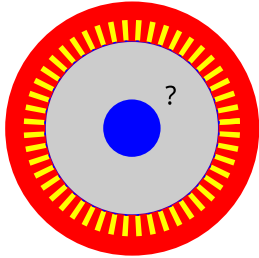
But what about...



859



But what about...



831

847

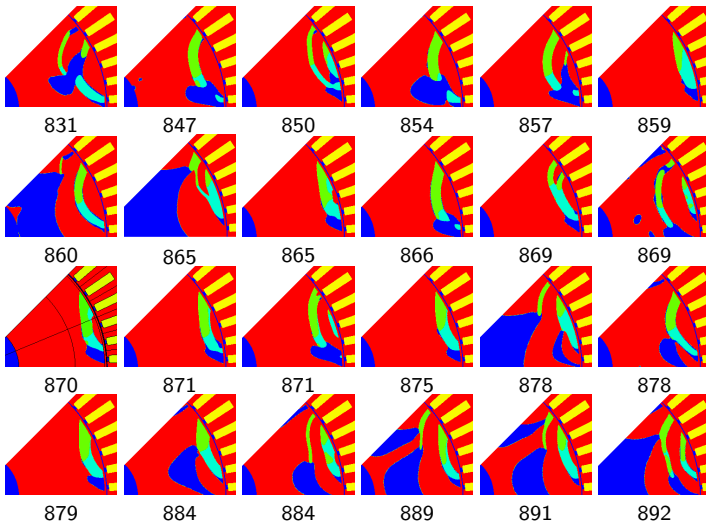
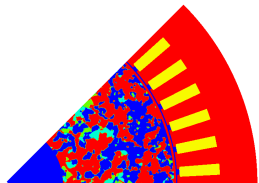
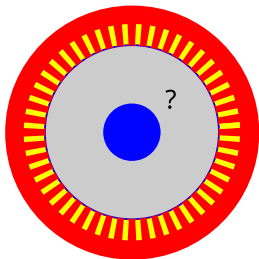
850

854

857

859

But what about...



Outlook

- Find more designs



L. Beck et. al, "Computing Multiple Local Minimizers for the Topology Optimization of Bipolar Plates in Electrolysis Cells", arxiv, 2024

- Combine multiphysics and multistart
- Consider real machine
- Voltage-driven operation
- Implement active short circuit
- Optimize orientation of permanent magnets

- Consider uncertainty in parameters and geometry



N. Krenn, T. Komann et. al, "Robust Topology Optimization of Electric Machines using Topological Derivatives", arxiv, 2025

- Optimize stator



T. Cherrière et. al, "Topology optimization of a complete reluctance machine with no initial information on its geometry", IEEE, 2024

- Optimize 3d structures

Thank you for your attention!

- Find more designs



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